

4 Mobile Platforms

six key multimedia features. The Samsung Motion gate (Motion UI) brings you access to your favorite multimedia features and speed dialing by tapping, tilting or flipping your handset. The Smart unlock feature a.k.a Gesture lock allows you to simultaneously unlock the phone and open a menu item or an application or dial a contact by drawing an alphabet letter on the screen when it is locked.

4.4.1 User Interface and homescreen

This interface is lively, colourful, pleasant and thumbable. Some of the new implementations of the TouchWiz UI such as in the Samsung Star and the Samsung Jet include three separate homescreens that you can alternate by swiping your fingers across the screen. The current home screen is indicated by three small boxes at the bottom of the screen or three thin bars at the top. Each homescreen is separately customisable.

Widgets are applications that you can put on your homescreen. You can also drag around widgets and arrange them as you wish. There are a variety of widgets available such as a calendar, weather monitor, MP3 player and an image gallery. Some Widgets are just shortcuts to applications and there are some widgets that let you configure the others. There are also other useful widgets which help you search for new widgets to download. The number of available widgets is increasing as the community grows, the fact that Samsung has released a dedicated software development kit for the TouchWiz UI ensures this. These widgets allow you to customise your phone beyond recognition. You can add as many widgets as you want to any of your homescreens. The widgets are on a vertical tray on the left side of the screen. You can open the tray and drag the widgets anywhere on the screen or drag widgets back from the screen to the tray.

The main menu displays as a grid of icons, while the submenus appear as lists. You have a tab at the bottom of the display which holds the three contextual keys with varying functionality according to the currently active menu. There are optional animations and transition effects throughout the interface which are a pleasure.

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Homescreen of a Samsung Star